

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University
QR828, Chatham Rd N, King's Park
Hung Hom, Kowloon, Hong Kong
Phone: (852)-3400-8061

To Whom It May Concern,

I am pleased to write this reference letter in strong support of Mr. ZHAO Xuecen (Jack), a fresh Mechanical Engineering graduate from The Hong Kong Polytechnic University. I know Jack through my course, ENG3004: Society and the Engineers, and through his contributions to Stairio, a university robotics project that I have been leading.

Jack was one of the strongest students in my course and achieved an A+ grade. More importantly, he stood out not only because of his academic performance, but also because of his curiosity, initiative, and ability to connect engineering knowledge with real-world problems. ENG3004 requires students to think beyond textbook engineering and consider how technology, society, responsibility, and practical implementation interact. Jack demonstrated exactly this kind of broad and mature engineering mindset.

In addition to his performance in class, I have also observed Jack's work through Stairio, an autonomous stairwell inspection robot project focused on cleanliness, pest, fire-safety, and maintenance inspection. Jack contributed across several important parts of the project, including the hardware control interface, detection logic, public landing page, product renders, and launch/demo materials. He also created a project video using motion graphics and intuitive user-interface demonstrations to explain the product workflow clearly. These contributions showed not only technical capability, but also strong product sense and communication ability.

What impressed me most about Jack is his ability to work across disciplinary boundaries. Although he is trained in mechanical engineering, he is comfortable engaging with robotics, embedded systems, software development, AI-assisted workflows, product communication, and practical system integration. This kind of cross-disciplinary capability is particularly valuable for modern robotics and IoT engineering, where real impact depends on the ability to integrate hardware, software, sensing, control, and user-facing design into a coherent working system.

Jack is proactive, self-motivated, and highly willing to learn independently. He does not wait passively for instructions; instead, he actively identifies what needs to be done, learns the required tools, and turns ideas into working outputs. In my experience, this is one of the clearest indicators of future success in engineering practice. He has the mindset of a builder: he enjoys creating practical systems, improving them through iteration, and presenting them in a way that others can understand and use.

I consider Jack one of the best students I have worked with. I have full confidence in his potential and am happy to give him my strongest support for engineering positions, especially in mechanical engineering, robotics, IoT, product engineering, automation, and related technical fields. I believe he will be a valuable contributor to any team that

values initiative, technical versatility, practical problem-solving, and the ability to learn quickly.

I recommend Jack without reservation. Please feel free to contact me if further information is required.

Sincerely,



Prof. Li-Ta Hsu

AFRIN, MION, SMIEEE
Limin Young Scholar in Aerospace Navigation
Associate Professor,
Department of Aeronautical and Aviation Engineering,
The Hong Kong Polytechnic University
Tel: (852) 3400-8061
Website: <https://www.polyu.edu.hk/aae/ipn-lab/us/index.html>